

SENATE RESOLUTION 264

By Harshbarger

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Appalachian Miles for Smiles.

WHEREAS, Appalachian Miles for Smiles is a faith-based ministry and nonprofit organization dedicated to delivering compassionate healthcare services to underserved and medically vulnerable populations throughout Northeast Tennessee and Southwest Virginia; and

WHEREAS, since its founding in 2016, Appalachian Miles for Smiles has provided free, life-changing healthcare services to approximately 21,000 individuals across more than fifteen counties in Tennessee and eight counties in Southwest Virginia, delivering an estimated ten million dollars in services back to local communities; and

WHEREAS, Appalachian Miles for Smiles operates five mobile medical units that function as traveling clinics, enabling the organization to reach rural and underserved areas where access to basic health care, particularly dental and vision services, is often limited; and

WHEREAS, the organization travels nine months out of the year and conducts twenty-four or more clinics annually, with each clinic operating as a two-day event to ensure meaningful access to care for those in need; and

WHEREAS, services provided through Appalachian Miles for Smiles clinics include dental and vision care, audiology and pulmonary services, mammograms, and women's health services, all offered at no cost to patients; and

WHEREAS, rooted in a mission of service and faith, Appalachian Miles for Smiles is committed to treating every individual with dignity, compassion, and respect, seeking not only to address physical healthcare needs but also to restore hope, promote wellness, and demonstrate genuine care for neighbors through acts of service and kindness; and

WHEREAS, through its continued dedication to improving lives and expanding access to essential health care, Appalachian Miles for Smiles exemplifies the power of community-driven service and compassionate outreach; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Appalachian Miles for Smiles for its outstanding service to underserved communities, extending our deepest appreciation for its commitment to compassionate health care and community well-being and our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.